# Esteban Nunez Perez

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## EDUCATION

**Princeton University** — Expected May 2027
*Bachelor of Science in Mechanical and Aerospace Engineering; Minor in Robotics* — Princeton, NJ

**Coursework:** Space System Design; Space Flight Dynamics; Rocket & Air Breathing Propulsion; Materials Science

## EXPERIENCE

**NASA** — June 2026 – Present
*Launch Vehicle Propulsion Engineering Pathways Intern* — Cape Canaveral, FL

- Propulsion engineer supporting commercial operations; conducting post flight data reviews, hardware flight readiness certifications, and supporting on-console launch operations (Space X, Blue Origin, ULA, etc.)
- Planning to sit on console for launch of SpaceX Commercial Resupply Services flight 35

**Princeton University – Beeson Group** — June 2025 – Present
*Research Assistant* — Princeton, NJ

- Conducted NASA-funded research on cislunar debris mitigation, developing a policy framework for incentive-based debris reduction and sustainable lunar operations
- Authored a 15-page technical-policy report evaluating governance mechanisms, operator incentives, and service-based mitigation strategies for the cislunar environment
- Invited to present research at the International Astronautical Congress 2026 in Antalya, Turkey

**United States Senate** — May – August 2024
*Senate Intern* — Washington D.C.

- Wrote daily briefs compiling legislative updates, stakeholder activity, and national trends to inform strategic decisions
- Aided in state and national stakeholder meetings, supporting priorities of legislative team

**Appareo Aviation** — May – August 2023
*Manufacturing Intern* — Fargo, ND

- Assembled avionics and agricultural products, ensuring compliance with design specifications while collaborating with senior engineers to troubleshoot integration issues and optimize the assembly process

## PROJECTS

**LUREX (Lunar Radiation Environment Explorer)** — January – May 2026
*Propulsion & Launch Vehicle Team Lead* — Princeton, NJ

- Led the propulsion and launch vehicle subsystem (4 students) in designing a SMEX-class lunar satellite mission
- Owned the propulsion system, ΔV budget, and propellant tank sizing that drove system architecture, presented the final design to Princeton University faculty and engineers from John's Hopkins Applied Physics Lab

**Search and Rescue Robot** — August – December 2025
*Team Lead* — Princeton, NJ

- Led a team of ten students in designing, fabricating, and testing a ~40lb autonomous search and rescue robot
- Designed the drivetrain and coordinated cross-subsystem integration, culminating in the only fully operational robot in the course

**Princeton Rocketry** — January 2025 – January 2026
*Airframe Sub-team Member* — Princeton, NJ

- Owned a fin redesign and strengthening campaign using composite manufacturing techniques for

## SKILLS

**Software & Programming:** Creo Parametric, Siemens NX, ANSYS (FEA & STK), NASA GMAT, MATLAB, Python, Java

**Manufacturing:** Composites, CNC, 3D-Printing, Metal Machining, GD&T

**Languages:** English & Spanish (native); French (limited working proficiency)

## CAMPUS INVOLVEMENT

**Varsity Football:** All conference walk-on kicker; 25+ hours per week — March 2024 – Present

**SHARE Peer:** Confidential peer resource for those affected by sexual and domestic violence — May 2025 – Present